

INTERNAL · CONFIDENTIAL

Paperless Business Banking

Position Paper

The case for compliant, self-serve, paperless service journeys

Field	Value
Author	Alan Davidson
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Position in brief

1 Our position

Business-banking service events that still rely on paper and branch visits should be re-imagined as guided, self-serve, digitally-signed journeys inside the banking app — with the regulatory controls built into the flow. Doing so reduces cost and delay, improves the customer experience, and can strengthen compliance by making every check explicit, consistent and logged.

This paper sets out the argument and points to a working front-end prototype that makes it concrete.

The problem

2 Paper is still in the critical path

Across mandates, payments, closures, disputes and onboarding, too many journeys still depend on posted forms, wet-ink signatures, faxed details and branch visits — costing days of delay, operational handling, error and rework.

- Delay: postal round-trips stretch simple changes into days.
- Cost: paper handling, re-keying and exception management carry real expense.
- Risk: manual steps introduce error and inconsistent control application.
- Experience: business customers expect to self-serve, any hour, any device.

The opportunity

3 Compliant self-serve, paperless by default

The controls these journeys require — identity, authorisation to the correct mandate, confirmation of payee, sanctions and PEP screening, cooling-off, audit — are precisely what software does consistently and at scale. Expressed inside the workflow, they enable a better experience rather than justify keeping paper.

Why now

4 The timing case

- Regulatory expectations (Consumer Duty, SCA, APP-fraud reimbursement) reward consistent, evidenced controls.
- Business customers increasingly expect parity with the best consumer digital experiences.
- Confirmation of Payee, digital identity and strong authentication are now mature building blocks.

Evidence

5 What the prototype demonstrates

A front-end concept prototype implements 17 paperless journeys across 7 business entity types, each replacing a specific paper or branch process and surfacing its regulatory controls — from mandate changes and bulk payments to disputes, cross-border beneficiary onboarding, balance certificates and device management. It is a clickable articulation of the position, not a production system.

Benefits

6 Who benefits, and how

Stakeholder	Benefit
Customer	Faster outcomes, self-serve any time, clear status, fewer branch visits

Bank	Lower handling cost, fewer exceptions, consistent controls, stronger audit
Regulatory	Controls made explicit and logged; fair treatment and cooling-off by design

Risks

7 Risks & mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Digital exclusion	Retain assisted routes; design for accessibility (WCAG AA).
Fraud / social engineering	Strong authentication, CoP, screening, cooling-off windows.
Regulatory change	Model controls as configurable policy, not hard-coded logic.
Adoption	Validate with customer research before scaling; prioritise high-value flows.

Recommendation

8 Recommendation

- Endorse the paperless, compliant-by-design model as the target for service journeys.
- Select a small set of highest-value journeys for a backend-integrated pilot.
- Fund structured customer research using the prototype as the discussion artefact.
- Define production integration, security and data-protection requirements in parallel.

Prototype only — no backend, no real data, no live system connections. Prepared for internal discussion.